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Fallout from war room chat spreads

CDC slices public health grant funds

By Jason Laughlin,
Christopher Gavin,
and Amanda Gokee

GLOBE STAFF

A sweeping effort by the Trump administration to reclaim billions in federal grant money is expected to cost New England states more than \$100 million that had been targeted for public health programs, state officials said Wednesday.

The exact amount in Massachusetts is unclear, but officials in Rhode Island expect the state to lose \$31 million, while New Hampshire is poised to lose \$80 million.

Losing the grants, which were distributed through the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, is “potentially devastating to public health,” Massachusetts Public Health Commissioner Dr. Robbie Goldstein said in a statement.

Massachusetts officials are still trying to calculate the loss of funds, but noted that much of some \$100 million in grants that were targeted is protected because the funds are already obligated; in other cases, the rescission would force Massachusetts to break existing contracts, state officials said.

The Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration has also abruptly terminated awards to Massachusetts’s Department of Mental Health.

Speaking Tuesday on WPRI, which first reported the cuts in Rhode Island, state Attorney General Peter Neronha said he plans to fight the rescission, noting the funding covered efforts such as childhood vaccination and the state’s response to future pandemics.

CDC, Page A6

CUTBACKS REACH SCHOOL LUNCHROOMS

Funds earmarked for locally sourced food were part of cuts by the administration, leaving school officials scrambling to find alternative funding. **B1.**

LATEST ROUND IN TARIFFS BATTLES

President Trump said he will impose 25 percent tariffs on auto imports, a move he says will bolster domestic manufacturing but could also raise prices. **D3.**

ICE agents grab student from street, send to La.



MIKE MATHIS

A video showed Tufts graduate student Rumeysa Ozturk, in white coat, being detained by federal immigration authorities on Tuesday in Somerville.

By Giulia McDonnell Nieto
del Rio and Mike Damiano

GLOBE STAFF

The Trump administration’s campaign against pro-Palestinian activists reached the Boston area Tuesday evening when an international PhD student at Tufts was arrested by masked federal immigration agents on a residential street and sent to a detention facility in Louisiana, according to federal immigration records and the student’s attorney.

Plainclothes officers handcuffed Rumeysa Ozturk, a 30-year-old Turkish national in the United States on a student visa, and loaded her into an unmarked SUV with tinted windows as she pleaded for explanations, according to video of the arrest. She was transferred to Louisiana despite a federal judge ordering US Immigration and Customs Enforcement Tuesday night not to remove Ozturk from Massachusetts without prior notice.

The exact timing of her transfer to Louisiana and the issuance of the judge’s order was unclear.

TUFTS, Page A7

‘This isn’t public safety. It’s intimidation that will, and should, be closely scrutinized in court.’

ANDREA CAMPBELL, *state attorney general*



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

A rally against the detention of a Tufts international student attracted several thousand protesters to an area near Powder House Park and the campus in Somerville.

Resist ‘attacks’ on colleges, Harvard professors say

By Hilary Burns
and Nick Stoico

GLOBE STAFF

Hundreds of Harvard professors on Wednesday called on university leaders to push back against the federal government’s “ongoing attacks on American universities,” saying in a letter to the school’s governing boards that the future of higher education is at stake.

The letter, signed by more than 590 people as of about 7 p.m., comes as universities across the country are grappling with a litany of investigations and funding threats that amount to an extraordinary crackdown on the country’s higher education sector. The letter, which the Globe obtained, marks one of academia’s most high-profile acts of resistance against the

administration’s policies so far.

Columbia University last week agreed to nearly every demand made by the Trump administration after it accused the Ivy League school of mishandling protests and campus antisemitism. The administration ordered changes in how Columbia handles student discipline, campus security, and even

HARVARD, Page A7

Democrats demand answers from national security team

By Abigail Hauslohner
and Warren P. Strobel

WASHINGTON POST

US intelligence chiefs faced new questions from Congress on Wednesday after the publication of additional text chains indicating that the Trump administration’s top national security officials shared detailed plans for an air attack on Yemen over a commercial messaging app.

The Atlantic magazine, which this week revealed the existence of the chat group to which its editor in chief was inadvertently added, published portions of the messages it had previously withheld.

The more complete transcript showed that Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth posted in the chat a detailed timeline of the planned strikes and listed the weapons to be used — including F-18 jets, MQ-9 Reaper drones, and sea-launched Tomahawk missiles. The magazine published the transcript a day after the administration’s top spy chiefs had insisted, under oath before a Senate panel, that the chats contained no classified information.

Democrats on the House Intelligence Committee immediately

LEAK, Page A6

Excerpts of Signal text messages

At 11:44 a.m. Saturday, March 15, Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth sent a timeline of the planned attack to participants in the chat.

TEAM UPDATE:

TIME NOW (1144et): Weather is FAVORABLE. Just CONFIRMED w/ CENTCOM we are a GO for mission launch.

1215et: F-18s LAUNCH (1st strike package)

1345: “Trigger Based” F-18 1st Strike Window Starts (Target Terrorist is @ his Known Location so SHOULD BE ON TIME) -- also, Strike Drones Launch (MQ-9s)

1410: More F-18s LAUNCH (2nd strike package)

1415: Strike Drones on Target (THIS IS WHEN THE FIRST BOMBS WILL DEFINITELY DROP, pending earlier “Trigger Based” targets)

1536: F-18 2nd Strike Starts -- also, first sea-based Tomahawks launched.

MORE TO FOLLOW (per timeline)

We are currently clean on OPSEC.

Godspeed to our Warriors.



A Cracker Jack day

Thursday: Sunny and breezy. High 47-52, low 36-41.

Friday: Clouds, rain move in. High 51-56, low 36-41.

Sunrise: 6:35. Sunset: 7:04.

Weather and comics, **D6-7.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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It’s Opening Day and the Red Sox are overdue

to turn expectations into winning results, writes columnist Christopher Gasper. **C1.**

The Supreme Court, in a 7-2 decision, upheld restrictions to kits

that can be easily assembled into homemade, nearly untraceable firearms known as “ghost guns.” **A2.**

With higher ed in turmoil, financial firms could swoop in and take advantage, columnist Kara Miller writes. **D1.**



BOSTON CHILDREN'S HOSPITAL/1964 FILE

John Enders’s research at Boston Children’s Hospital led to the development of the measles vaccine.

From Children’s Hospital, a halt to endemic scourge

Measles vaccine had origins in Boston lab

By Kay Lazar

GLOBE STAFF

Dr. I. George Miller doesn’t remember the exact year, but he clearly recalls the misery of burning with fever from measles. It was in the 1940s, and Miller was a youngster, lying in bed as his mother wrapped him with cool, wet sheets, urgently trying to lower his temperature.

Back then, most children in the United States developed measles before the age of 15. Tens of thousands were hospitalized each year and hundreds died.

Miller could have hardly imagined in those feverish hours that a

pioneering Boston scientist would create a vaccine to spare countless other children from the misery he was experiencing. Nor did he envision that the scientist, Dr. John Enders, would one day become his own mentor, opening the door to a remarkable career in science for Miller as well.

Enders conducted this extraordinary research at Boston Children’s Hospital (then known as Children’s Hospital Medical Center) in the late 1950s and early 1960s. Miller was in his last year at Harvard Medical School in 1961 when he was introduced

MEASLES, Page A10